

# Settlement Reconciliation Portal

## Part 1 — UX & Product Framing

Client Portal Engineer Take-Home · Rapyd Scale R&D · Merchant M-104

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### The User

A merchant finance or operations user who logs in to verify that their settlements match their own records — and when they don't, to understand *why* without filing a support ticket.

### Core Journeys

#### Journey 1 — "Am I okay?" (Daily health check)

The merchant opens the portal and within 5 seconds knows: how many transactions were checked, how many matched, and whether anything needs attention. If everything matches, they see a clear, reassuring confirmation — not an empty page. This is the most common outcome and should feel like a reward, not an afterthought.

#### Journey 2 — "What went wrong?" (Exception investigation)

When exceptions exist, the merchant filters and sorts to find the ones that matter — typically amount mismatches first (financial impact), then missing records. They click into a detail drawer to see the settlement vs. ledger side-by-side, understand the discrepancy type, and optionally get an AI-generated plain-English explanation. The language throughout avoids alarm: "needs attention" not "missing funds."

#### Journey 3 — "Give me the data" (Export for internal review)

The merchant exports exceptions as CSV for their own accounting team or to attach to a support ticket if escalation is needed. Export is scoped to the current filter state so they can send just the relevant exceptions.

# States

| State       | What the merchant sees                                                                                                                                                                       | Design intent                                                                                                                 |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Loading     | Page header + skeleton stat tiles + skeleton table rows + blue info banner: "Reconciling your transactions..."                                                                               | Structural continuity — layout doesn't shift when data arrives. Informational tone, not a spinner.                            |
| All-clear ✓ | Green status banner: "All 15 transactions matched." Stat tiles show 15/15/0/None. No table (nothing to show).                                                                                | The most common daily outcome. Treated as a first-class success state — reassuring, prominent, not an empty page.             |
| Error       | Centered error message: "Unable to load reconciliation data." Reassurance: "Your data is safe." Primary CTA: Try again. Secondary: Contact support.                                          | Calm, not alarming. Never implies data loss. Gives the merchant a clear next action.                                          |
| Populated   | Amber status banner with count. Four stat tiles (checked/matched/exceptions/impact by currency). Exception breakdown pills. Filter bar. Paginated sortable table. Row click → detail drawer. | Information hierarchy: status → impact → investigate → act. Dense enough for daily operational use, calm enough to not alarm. |

# Information Architecture

|         |  |                                       |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
|---------|--|---------------------------------------|--|--------|--|------------|--|-------------|--|
| TOP BAR |  | Rapyd logo                            |  | Portal |  | Production |  | Avatar      |  |
|         |  |                                       |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
|         |  | Settlement Reconciliation             |  |        |  |            |  | [Export ▼]  |  |
| Side    |  | Jul 1-21, 2026 · Data as of 09:15 UTC |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
| Nav     |  |                                       |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
|         |  | ⚠ 5 of 15 transactions need attention |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
| Home    |  | 10 matched. 5 have discrepancies.     |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
| Collect |  |                                       |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
| ■Recon  |  |                                       |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |
| Reports |  | 15                                    |  | 10     |  | 5          |  | \$24.31 USD |  |
| Settin  |  | Chkd                                  |  | Match  |  | Excep      |  | 148.65 AED  |  |
|         |  |                                       |  |        |  |            |  |             |  |

```
| | [Amount mismatch·1] [Not in ledger·1] ...
```

```
| | Reason ▾ From To [Search]
```

```
| | ┌──────────────────────────┐ |
```

| ID    | Reason    | Date | Settl | Ldgr  | Diff |
|-------|-----------|------|-------|-------|------|
| T1013 | Amt mis.. | Jul8 | 267.8 | 243.5 | -24  |
| T1006 | No ldgr   | Jul1 | 1384  | -     | -    |
| ...   |           |      |       |       |      |

```
| | View→|
```

```
| | └──────────────────────────┘ |
```

```
| | 5 of 5 exceptions Page 1 of 1
```

DETAIL DRAWER (right)

T1013 – Amount mismatch

[Details] [Settlement vs. Ledger] [AI Explain]

Settlmt

\$267.80

Ledger

\$243.49

Diff: -\$24.31 USD

AI explanation

AI-generated – verify details

The settlement is \$24.31 higher than your ledger entry. This is consistent with a processing fee adjustment applied post-entry.

[Download Receipt]

[Contact Support]

## Key Design Decisions

- **Status as a sentence, not just a number.** "5 of 15 transactions need attention" is immediately parseable. A badge with "5" requires context the user has to assemble.
- **Financial impact by currency, never summed.** Multi-currency merchants cannot sum \$24.31 USD + 148.65 AED — showing them as separate chips respects the data's real structure.

- **Exception ≠ lost money.** Every label uses neutral language: "needs attention," "discrepancy," "doesn't match." Never "missing funds" or "error." The AI explanation carries an explicit "AI-generated — verify details" label.
- **Tabbed detail drawer over modal.** The table stays visible and scroll-locked behind the drawer, preserving context. Tabs separate factual data (Settlement vs. Ledger) from the AI explanation — the AI is secondary and opt-in.
- **Rapyd's design system.** Purple (#5C2D91) accent, sidebar nav with left-border active state, pill-shaped status badges, right-side drawer — all match the existing Client Portal so this page feels native, not bolted on.

## Definition of Done

### UX commitment: WCAG 2.1 AA baseline

- All status indicators use icon + text label, never color alone
- Exception table is keyboard-navigable (Tab through rows, Enter to open drawer)
- Semantic HTML: `<table>` , `<thead>` , `aria-sort` on sortable columns, `aria-live` on status region
- Minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio on all text; 3:1 on large text and UI components
- Responsive: table scrolls horizontally on narrow screens; stat tiles stack 2×2; drawer becomes full-screen on mobile

### Business metric: "Where's my money?" ticket reduction

Primary metric: % **reduction in settlement-related support tickets** within 30 days of launch, measured against the same merchant cohort's baseline. Target: 40%+ reduction. Secondary signal: portal adoption rate (DAU/MAU of merchants who have active reconciliation data) and time-to-resolution for tickets that still come in (merchants who self-served first should arrive with better context).

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AI tools used: Claude was used to generate UX direction explorations, analyze Rapyd's existing portal design system from screenshots, and structure this document. All product decisions, information hierarchy, and language choices reflect the author's judgment.